outreach to Latin America, the Caribbean, Pacific Islands and Oceania is also now distinctly visible. How much India can exploit the opportunities that await depends to a great degree on this broader engagement.

Like other major powers, India too has turned to development partnerships as a significant instrument in its diplomatic tool kit. And it has done so in its own unique India Way. Overall, it has offered 300 Lines of Credit to sixty-four countries involving 540 projects. The bulk of the LoCs and projects are with Africa, now at 321 projects involving 205 LoCs. In addition, India currently has 181 projects in Asia, thirty-two in Latin America and Caribbean and three each in Central Asia and Oceania. These initiatives have qualitatively expanded in recent years, especially in terms of the size of the LoCs and the complexity of the projects. Their planning and execution has also become more efficient by a more integrated approach and stronger oversight. The dispersal of grant assistance is even broader than the Lines of Credit, covering virtually all developing regions of the world. Africa has been a particular focus of attention, partly as a reflection of our solidarity born out of shared struggles. But it is also an aspect of strategy, as the rise of Africa will add to the multipolarity of the world. As others have discovered before, such development partnerships provide the foundation for long-lasting relationships.

Prominent Indian-supported projects cover the power sector in Sudan, Rwanda, Zimbabwe and Malawi; water in Mozambique, Tanzania and Guinea; health in Cote d’Ivoire, Guinea and Zambia; sugar plants in Ethiopia and Ghana; cement in Djibouti and Republic of Congo; and government buildings in the Gambia and Burundi. In fact, in several African countries, some of the manufacturing plants we have set up are truly the first of their kind. This steady growth in Indian interests in Africa is reflected in an expanded footprint and a deeper engagement: 51 out of 54 nations of that continent host such development projects, while the training collaboration covers 10,000 Africans annually. Two digital initiatives are also on a pilot mode in Africa today – the e-Vidya Bharati distance education and the e-Aarogya Bharati distance health. More than the cooperation itself, this aspect of India’s foreign policy underlines its progressive emergence on the global stage.